

HERITAGE AUCTIONS CONSOLIDATED GLOSSARY

A unified, non-repeating master reference compiled from Heritage Auctions' primary numismatic and currency databases.

Term	Source Portal	Comprehensive Definition
10 Mil	<i>Coin Terms</i>	A unit of measurement describing a width or length of 1/100 of an inch, usually referring specifically to the thickness of metal plating on a medal or coin.
Abrasions	<i>Coin Terms</i>	Areas of a coin where contact with another coin or a foreign object has physically displaced or abraded metal on its surface.
Accumulation	<i>Coin Terms</i>	A random grouping of a particular date, type, or series (e.g., an accumulation of Morgan Dollars). Often denotes a monetary hoard as opposed to a systematic coin collection.
Album Slide Marks	<i>Coin Terms</i>	Lines, frequently parallel, imparted to a coin's surface by the friction of a plastic slide inside a storage album. Most common on proof surfaces; minor rubbing on high points is termed album friction.
Altered Surfaces	<i>Coin Terms</i>	Cleaning, tooling, dipping, or other chemical and physical modifications that mask flaws or render a coin less desirable to advanced numismatists.
Ancients	<i>Coin Terms</i>	General classification for historical world coins struck from approximately 600 B.C. through the fall of antiquity at circa 450 A.D.
Annealing	<i>Coin Terms</i>	The rigorous heating and cooling process applied to a coin die or planchet blank to soften the metal structural layout before die preparation or coin striking.
Appraised	<i>Collectible Terms</i>	An item evaluated by an expert on the Heritage staff, deemed authentic, and explicitly graded according to established industry metrics.

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Bag Marks	<i>Coin Terms</i>	Minor dings and surface nicks acquired by uncirculated coins as they clash against each other inside cloth transit bags at the mint. Coins may also develop rich bag toning due to metal-reactive sulfur within the bag weave.
Basal State	<i>Coin Terms</i>	The absolute base condition of a coin where it remains identifiable solely by its major design type, date, or mintmark, with maximum surface wear. Also known as Poor (PO-1).
Brilliant Uncirculated (BU)	<i>Coin Terms</i>	A generic term for a coin that has never entered circulation, fully maintaining its original frosty cartwheel or mirror-like prooflike luster without tarnish or friction.
Fractional Currency	<i>Currency Terms</i>	Paper money printed in denominations of less than one dollar. Extensively introduced by the U.S. Treasury during the Civil War era to stabilize the economy when physical coinage was hoarded due to its intrinsic metallic value.
Mule Notes	<i>Currency Terms</i>	Banknotes that accidentally display mismatched printing plate features. In small-size notes, a mule is produced when a face plate with a micro plate number (0.6mm) is paired with a back plate showing a macro plate number (1.0mm) due to the BEP policy of using up obsolete plates.
Obsolete Bank Notes	<i>Currency Terms</i>	Also referred to as Broken Bank Notes. Currency issued by private, state-chartered banks or local communities prior to the establishment of the Federal Reserve system.
Star Notes	<i>Currency Terms</i>	Replacement banknotes printed to take the place of a sheet that was misprinted or damaged during production. Identified by a small printed star symbol next to the serial layout number.
Web Notes	<i>Currency Terms</i>	Experimental currency pieces produced by the BEP between 1992 and 1995 using a continuous roll-fed web intaglio press instead of flat sheets. Easily identified by relocated front and back plate numbering coordinates.